

FOUNDER SHOWCASE · NYC · AUG 2026

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# The Shortlist

Six early-stage founders. One stage.

Skip the job-board black hole — hear the real story.

**6** founders · **all** hiring · **1** room

Hosted at Company Ventures · Curated by The Shortlist (Andrew Yeung & team)

# North

north.cloud

**Matt Biringer (CEO) · Yassine Açoine (CTO)**

*A financial operating system for cloud, AI & data spend.*

## PROBLEM

Engineers create the spend, finance is accountable for it — and nobody owns the seam between them.

## WHAT MAKES THEM UNIQUE

One layer across AWS/Azure/GCP + AI token spend + data warehouses, with autonomous commitment buying.

## RECENT MOMENTUM

Shipped North v3 (Aug 2026): Azure + native OpenAI/Anthropic/Snowflake. Series A led by Companyon.

## HIRING

**Engineering · GTM · Customer Success · Marketing**

# Antimetal

antimetal.com

**Matthew Parkhurst (CEO) · Shreyas Iyer (CTO)**

*"Production that runs itself."*

## PROBLEM

AI made writing code cheap. Operating and maintaining what you ship didn't shrink — it grew.

## WHAT MAKES THEM UNIQUE

Builds a "world model" of your systems — finds issues, diagnoses root cause, fixes, then verifies & hardens.

## RECENT MOMENTUM

\$24.3M from Sound Ventures, Nat Friedman, Naval, and the founders of Box & Dropbox.

## HIRING

**Engineering (infra/product/platform) · Design · GTM**

# Headstart

headstart.nyc

**Nicole Hedley (CEO) · Chris Hedley**

*Builds production agentic systems for enterprises.*

## PROBLEM

The AI frontier moves faster than any company can actually implement it — keeping up is a full-time job.

## WHAT MAKES THEM UNIQUE

One-to-many deployment through private-equity portfolios; an agent system that deploys agent systems.

## RECENT MOMENTUM

Bootstrapped & profitable from day zero (turned down term sheets). Subject of an Anthropic case study.

## HIRING

**Applied-AI Product Managers · Engineers**

# Arist

arist.co

**Michael Ioffe (CEO) · Ryan Lavery**

*Agents that automate management consulting.*

## PROBLEM

Execs don't know their org's real problems — and finding out means a \$5M McKinsey engagement.

## WHAT MAKES THEM UNIQUE

Interview thousands of employees, diagnose the org, then execute the fix. Origin: SMS learning in Yemen.

## RECENT MOMENTUM

\$22.5M Series B (Aug 2026); UKG-backed; powers the U.S. Dept. of Labor's AI-literacy program.

## HIRING

**Generalists who want extreme ownership**

# PointOne

pointone.com

**Jeremy Ben-Meir (CTO) · Katon Luaces (CEO)**

*AI for the business of law & professional services.*

## PROBLEM

Timekeeping — a firm's revenue engine — is manual, lossy, and universally hated.

## WHAT MAKES THEM UNIQUE

Passive capture turns the workday into compliant, complete time entries; then bill review & pricing.

## RECENT MOMENTUM

\$16M Series A led by 8VC (Bessemer, General Catalyst, YC). 10x revenue in six months.

## HIRING

**Engineers — at pace with revenue**

# Thunder

thunder.inc

**Dilip Rajan (CEO) + co-founders**

*Agents that run B2B paid growth end-to-end.*

## PROBLEM

Growth context is fragmented across tools; ad budgets are 7–8 figures and every call is high-stakes.

## WHAT MAKES THEM UNIQUE

They don't sell you software — they run your Google & LinkedIn ad channels for you, end to end.

## RECENT MOMENTUM

Pre-seed from Company Ventures; founder built BuzzFeed Quizzes & sold Jumpcut.

## HIRING

**Founding Growth Lead (forward-deployed) · Engineers**



THE PATTERN IN THE ROOM

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Five of six build AI that  
*operates* —  
not AI that *writes*.

Production ops

Cloud & AI spend

Org diagnosis

Back-office compliance

Ad execution

In 2026 the bottleneck moved from **making** software to **running** it. This room is where that bet gets staffed.

All six are hiring · warm intros via The Shortlist